

Globex Corporation

Virtual Private Network (VPN) Usage Policy

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Classification:	Internal Use Only
Owner:	Information Security Team
Approved By:	Diana Montoya, VP of Information Technology

1. Purpose

This policy defines the requirements and acceptable use practices for connecting to the Globex Corporation network via Virtual Private Network (VPN). The VPN provides encrypted remote access to internal systems, applications, and data resources. All employees, contractors, and authorized third parties who access the corporate network remotely must comply with this policy.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all Globex Corporation employees, temporary staff, contractors, consultants, and business partners who use VPN to access internal network resources from outside the corporate office. This includes access from home offices, co-working spaces, hotels, airports, and any other remote location.

3. Approved VPN Client

Globex Corporation uses GlobalProtect as its approved VPN client. No other VPN software is authorized for connecting to the corporate network. The IT Help Desk can assist with installation and configuration.

Download and setup instructions are available on the IT Self-Service Portal at <https://itportal.globex.internal/vpn-setup>.

4. Device Requirements

VPN access is permitted from the following device categories:

- **Company-issued devices:** All company-issued laptops and desktops are pre-configured with the VPN client and are approved for full network access. No additional setup is required.
- **Personal devices (BYOD):** Employees may use personal devices to connect to the VPN under the following conditions: the device must run a supported operating system (Windows 11, macOS 14 or later, Ubuntu 22.04 LTS or later), the device must have full-disk encryption enabled, the device must have up-to-date antivirus software installed and active, and the employee must complete the BYOD enrollment form through the IT Self-Service Portal. Personal devices are granted limited network access and cannot reach financial systems, HR databases, or production environments.
- **Mobile devices:** Smartphones and tablets may access email and calendar through the Globex Mobile App, which uses a separate secure channel. Direct VPN access from mobile devices is not supported.

5. Authentication

All VPN connections require multi-factor authentication (MFA). Employees must authenticate using their corporate Active Directory credentials and a second factor via the Globex Authenticator app. Hardware security keys (FIDO2) are also accepted as a second factor. SMS-based authentication is not supported.

VPN sessions time out after 12 hours of continuous connection or 30 minutes of inactivity. Employees must re-authenticate after a timeout.

6. Acceptable Use

The VPN is provided exclusively for business use. Employees connected to the VPN must observe the following:

- Do not use the VPN to access content that violates the Globex Acceptable Use Policy (IT-POL-2024-001).
- Do not share VPN credentials with any other person, including family members or colleagues.
- Do not use split tunneling or third-party proxy services while connected to the VPN.
- Do not leave a VPN session connected and unattended on an unlocked device.
- Disconnect the VPN when it is no longer needed for work.

7. Network Access Tiers

VPN users are assigned to one of three access tiers based on their role and device type:

Tier	Access Level	Eligible Users
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Standard	Internal apps, file shares, intranet, collaboration tools	All employees on company devices
Limited	Internal apps, intranet, collaboration tools only	BYOD users, contractors
Privileged	Full network access including production environments	Test/Prod Dev/Ops/Sec (requires manager approval)

Tier assignments are managed by the Identity and Access Management (IAM) team. To request a tier change, submit a request through the IT Self-Service Portal with manager approval.

8. Logging and Monitoring

All VPN connections are logged and monitored by the Information Security team. Logs include connection timestamps, source IP addresses, duration, bytes transferred, and resources accessed. Logs are retained for 90 days in accordance with the Data Retention Policy (IT-POL-2024-003). Anomalous activity, including connections from unusual geographic locations or access to restricted resources, may trigger automated alerts and investigation.

9. International Travel

Employees traveling internationally must notify the IT Security team at least five business days before departure by submitting a Travel Access Request through the IT Self-Service Portal. VPN access from certain countries is restricted due to regulatory and security requirements. The Security team will confirm whether access is available from the destination country and may issue a temporary travel laptop with additional security controls.

10. Violations

Violations of this policy may result in immediate suspension of VPN access and disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. Suspected security incidents should be reported immediately to the Security Operations Center at soc@globex.com or extension 4400.

11. Contact

Team	Contact	Hours
IT Help Desk	helpdesk@globex.com / ext. 4200	Mon-Fri 7am-7pm ET
Security Operations Center	soc@globex.com / ext. 4400	24/7
IAM Team	iam@globex.com	Mon-Fri 9am-5pm ET